

new games and other related info. When you tap on an individual item in the Spotlight view, Internet Explorer launches for you to know more about it.

Xbox Live

In this section, you'll find some basic information from your Xbox Live account; this will include your avatar, Gamertag, Name, Gamerscore and your last achievement. Because Xbox Live is cross-platform, that achievement could come from any of the supported platforms – Xbox 360, Windows or Windows Phone. Many of the items on this screen are links to web-based content. If you tap your avatar, Gamertag, etc you'll be taken online to find out more.

Remember that Windows Phone supports only a sub-set of the overall Xbox Live features or, as Microsoft describes it, the Xbox Live features that make sense on the phone. One of the obvious differences is the avatar: On the Xbox 360 console, your avatar is quite animated, and if you leave him alone onscreen, he'll bound around in amusing ways. On Windows Phone, without the updates at least, the avatar is decidedly less animated.

Game requests utilize the same onscreen overlay as incoming phone calls, messages and voicemails and they can interrupt you when you're doing something else on the phone, giving you the opportunity to drop what you're doing and pick up a game. If you choose to ignore such notifications, or are simply away from the phone when they show up, these pending game invitations and other request-related notifications are delivered into the Game hub. You can view them in the Requests section.

There are three possible request types you can find here:

- ▶ **Invitation:** When someone asks you to join them in a game online, an invitation is generated.
- ▶ **Your Turn:** Windows Phone provides support for asynchronous, turn-based games such as Backgammon, Scrabble and so on. In such games, the two players take turns in isolation and then alert each other that it's their turn through this interface. This is a neat idea, and it makes even very casual game experiences a social experience you can have, over time, with other people.
- ▶ **Nudge:** If someone hasn't gotten a response from you in a while, they can send a nudge, which is like a gentle reminder that they're still waiting on you.

Playing games

To play a game at any time, tap its thumbnail in the Collection view. Games are, of course, unique experiences. Some will work only in the portrait view